

PRIOR AUTHORIZATION CLINICAL SUBMISSION

Request / Insurance Information

PA Request ID	PA-2026-SC07
Submission Date	12-Aug-2026
Insurance/Payer	Aetna
Policy Type	Clinical Policy Bulletin (CPB)
Policy ID	CPB 0660
Policy Title	Knee Arthroplasty
Member ID	AET-SC07-1006
Policy Review Date	Last Review 02/26/2026; Next Review 07/23/2026
Coverage Order	Primary

Clinical/Orthopedic note

Patient	Michael Carter, 68-year-old male
Diagnosis	Primary osteoarthritis of right knee (M17.11)
Knee affected	Right knee
Pain severity	8/10
Functional limitation / ADL impact	Pain limits walking, stairs, prolonged standing, and other activities of daily living.
Physical examination	Tenderness, crepitus, mild effusion, and pain with weight-bearing.
Range of motion	Flexion approximately 95°; extension deficit approximately 5°.
Crepitus / effusion	Moderate crepitus with mild effusion.
Diagnosis history	Progressive osteoarthritis documented for approximately 3 years.
Treatment history	Non-surgical management attempted.
Physician recommendation	Right total knee arthroplasty recommended because of persistent pain and functional disability.
Insurance coordination	Patient reports active Aetna commercial coverage and Medicare coverage. The submitted insurance records identify Aetna as primary and Medicare as secondary.

Conservative treatment record

Physical therapy	Supervised in-person physical therapy
Duration	12 weeks within the past year
NSAIDs / analgesics	NSAIDs/acetaminophen used
Exercise	Flexibility and muscle-strengthening exercises
Activity modification	High-impact activity reduced
Injections	One therapeutic knee injection >12 weeks before planned surgery
Assistive device	Cane used
Response to treatment	Persistent symptoms despite treatment

Imaging report

Imaging type	Standing AP/lateral/weight-bearing knee radiographs
Date	28-Jul-2026
Knee	Right
Radiographic findings	Joint-space narrowing, osteophytes, and subchondral sclerosis.
Severity of osteoarthritis	Moderate-to-severe; Kellgren-Lawrence Grade 3–4.
Other relevant findings	No acute fracture or dislocation.

Supporting documents

HbA1c	7.1% measured 18-Jul-2026
Comorbidities	Type 2 diabetes and hypertension, clinically managed.
Previous surgery	No previous right-knee osteotomy or arthroplasty.
Previous knee replacement	None.
Contraindications	No active infection, open wound, recent corticosteroid injection, or documented implant allergy.
Secondary Payer	Medicare / CMS
Secondary Policy Type	Local Coverage Determination (LCD)
Secondary Policy ID	L36007
Secondary Policy Title	Lower Extremity Major Joint Replacement (Hip and Knee)
Secondary Member ID	MED-SC07-1006
Secondary Coverage Order	Secondary